

TECHNOLOGY STUDENT ASSOCIATION WORK LOG

#	Date	Task	Time	Team Members	Comments
1	Nov 1, 2025	Initial Brainstorming	2 hrs	SP, AA, AK, NS, VM, GM	The whole team sat down together to figure out what we wanted to build. We discussed ideas including animated particle backgrounds, which pages to include, and whether to integrate Google Calendar for events. We settled on an initial color scheme of green and white. By the end of the session we had a clear enough direction to begin development.
2	Nov 2–8, 2025	Initial Development & Hard Coding	8.5 hrs	SP, AK, NS, VM	We started writing code quickly to get something on screen. We built a homepage with a green and white color scheme, got particle animations running in the background, and set up basic layouts for each planned page. Much of this code was messy and repetitive, with styles hard-coded and copy-pasted in multiple places. The goal was to see the product take shape fast, knowing we would clean it up in the next phase.
3	Nov 8–15, 2025	Refactoring & Code Organization	5.5 hrs	SP, AA, AK	After the initial build the codebase was difficult to work with. Repeated button styles and layout patterns were copy-pasted across multiple files. We went through everything and extracted repeated pieces into reusable components. For example, instead of rebuilding the navbar on every page we created a single Navbar component imported everywhere. This made future development much faster, with changes only needing to be made in one place.
4	Nov 15–22, 2025	Backend: Database & API Setup	8 hrs	AK, VM	Up to this point the site was completely static. We set up a backend using Supabase, which provided a real database and API without requiring us to build and host a server from scratch. We created tables to store submitted events, wrote logic to insert records when users fill out forms, and made sure the frontend could read and display that data. This turned the site from a static brochure into something that could receive and store real user input.
5	Nov 15–22, 2025	Backend: API Routes & Form Handling	5 hrs	AK, VM	With the database in place we needed frontend forms to actually communicate with it. We wrote API route handlers that receive form submissions, validate incoming data (checking required fields and email formatting), and insert valid records into the correct Supabase table. We also added basic error handling so that if something goes wrong on the database side the user sees a clear message rather than a blank screen.
6	Dec 21, 2025	Strategic Review & Planning	1 hr	SP, AA, AK, NS, VM, GM	We reviewed everything built so far and made an honest list of what still felt off. The site was functional but the green and white design was starting to feel plain and inconsistent. Font sizes did not always match, spacing was uneven, and a few pages felt unfinished. We decided to plan a full visual redesign before the January submission deadline, divided up the work, and confirmed the Events page needed to be ready for submission.
7	Dec 22, 2025 – Jan 18, 2026	UI Overhaul & Pre-Submission Polish	15 hrs	SP, AA, AK, NS, VM, GM	This was the longest stretch of work before the January submission. We fixed inconsistencies in typography, spacing, and layout across all existing pages. The particle animations that had been slightly jittery got smoothed out. We standardized the green and white color palette so it looked intentional and consistent rather than slapped together. We also made sure the homepage, Events page, and navigation were polished enough to present for the regional submission.
8	Jan 22, 2026	Events Page Development	6 hrs	AK, NS, VM	We built out the Events page in time for the submission deadline the next day. It uses a bento grid layout where cards can be different sizes depending on how important the event is, and includes an interactive calendar so users can browse events by date. A lot of the time went into making the cards readable and well-spaced and ensuring the page did not fall apart on smaller screens.

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9	Jan 23, 2026	Regional Submission	N/A	SP, AA, AK, NS, VM, GM	Submitted the website for the TSA regional competition. At this point the site had a green and white design with a working homepage, particle animations, an Events page with a calendar, and backend form handling for event submissions. Features not yet built included the interactive map, the resources directory, the donations and wishlist system, the about page, and dark mode.
10	Jan 28, 2026	Post-Submission: Major Redesign Kickoff	4 hrs	SP, AA, AK, NS, VM, GM	With the regional submission out of the way we started a major visual redesign. The green and white color scheme was replaced with a darker, more modern palette. We restructured several page layouts from scratch while keeping the underlying codebase and components we had already built. The goal was to make the site feel significantly more polished for the state-level competition and to create a better foundation for all the new features we were about to add.
11	Jan 28, 2026	Interactive Map Integration	4 hrs	NS, AK, VM	We added an interactive map using Leaflet, which lets you embed a fully clickable and zoomable map without needing a paid API key. The tricky part was that Next.js tries to run code on the server before sending it to the browser, and Leaflet only works in the browser, so it kept crashing during the server-side step. We fixed it using dynamic imports and a mounting guard, which tells the app to wait until the page is fully loaded in the browser before initializing the map.
12	Feb 3, 2026	Resources Page Development	8 hrs	AK, VM, SP	The Resources page is a directory of local organizations and services that community members can actually use. We built it with a search bar that filters results in real time as you type, and dropdown filters to narrow results by category. Each resource appears as a card you can expand to see more details, including a small embedded map showing the location and a direct contact link. Getting the search and filter logic to work together cleanly without the page flickering took most of the day.
13	Feb 3, 2026	Backend: Resource Data & Search API	4 hrs	VM, AK	We built the backend logic to serve and filter resources data. Resources are stored in Supabase and queried dynamically based on what the user types or selects. We wrote a server-side function that takes the search term and category filter as parameters and builds the appropriate database query, so only matching results come back instead of loading everything and filtering in the browser. This keeps the page fast even if the database grows to hundreds of entries.
14	Feb 10, 2026	Design System Refinement	2 hrs	VM, AA, NS	After the redesign we noticed that icons across different pages were coming from different sources and did not quite match. Some were outlined, some filled, some slightly different sizes. We picked one icon library and swapped everything out to use it consistently. We also decided on a rule for which icon maps to which action across the site so that future additions would stay consistent without having to make judgment calls each time.
15	Feb 14, 2026	Donations & Wishlist System	8 hrs	NS, SP, AK	We built an interactive donation and wishlist feature that lets users see what the community needs and contribute toward specific items. Each wishlist entry has an animated progress bar that fills up as donations come in, and the dollar totals update dynamically so the page always shows the current number without needing a manual refresh. The hardest part was making sure the numbers updated correctly in real time when multiple users were on the page at the same time.
16	Feb 14, 2026	Backend: Donations Logic & Real-Time Sync	4 hrs	VM, AK	On the backend side of the donations feature we set up Supabase real-time subscriptions so the page automatically updates when a new donation is recorded without needing a page refresh. We wrote the database logic to increment the total for the correct wishlist item when a donation comes in, and added server-side validation to make sure donation amounts are positive numbers and that the item being donated to actually exists in the database before anything gets updated.
17	Feb 18, 2026	Submit Resource Form	4 hrs	SP, AA, NS	We built a form that lets community members submit new resources to be added to the directory. Fields include the resource name, category, description, contact info, and location. Users can also upload multiple photos at once and see a live preview of

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					what they have selected before submitting. Every field has validation so the form will not submit if the description is blank or if uploaded files are not valid image types.
18	Feb 24, 2026	About Page Development	4 hrs	AA, NS, AK	The About page tells the story of the project, why we built it, who we are, and what we hope it does for the community. We laid it out so it reads like a narrative: starting with the problem, moving into our solution, and ending with the team. The goal was for someone landing on this page to understand what Community Connect is about within the first 30 seconds of reading, without having to dig for information.
19	Mar 1, 2026	Accessibility & Settings	6 hrs	AK, NS, VM	We added a Settings panel that lets users control how the site looks and feels. Options include dark mode, a zoom slider so text can be made larger, and a high-contrast mode for users with visual impairments. All preferences are saved to localStorage so they persist between visits. This took longer than expected because each setting had to propagate correctly to every component on the page without getting overridden by a conflicting stylesheet.
20	Mar 5, 2026	Bug Fixing	2 hrs	AK, NS	We ran into a bug where the navbar was shifting out of position on certain pages. After debugging we traced it to a CSS transform applied to the root HTML element that was thrown off by animation work, affecting how the browser calculated the navbar's fixed position. The actual fix was small once we found the cause, but narrowing it down took a while because the bug only appeared on specific pages and did not show up at all in the local development environment.
21	Mar 7, 2026	Dark Mode Completion	6 hrs	NS, AK, SP	Dark mode had been partially implemented since the settings panel was added, but several pages and components still had not been updated to respond to it. We went through every page methodically and checked light and dark mode side by side. Several components, particularly the resource cards and donation progress bars, had hardcoded light colors that did not switch when dark mode was toggled. We replaced all of those with CSS variables so they respond automatically.
22	Mar 10, 2026	Copyright Checklist Page	3 hrs	SP, AA, VM	TSA requires the website to document all third-party assets used and confirm they are properly licensed. We built a dedicated page listing every external library, font, icon set, and image source we used, with a link to each license. We formatted it as a checklist so a judge can quickly verify each item has been reviewed. Tracking down the exact license type for every asset took some time since some libraries use MIT, some use Apache 2.0, and some required attribution in a specific format.
23	Mar 12, 2026	Work Log Page	2 hrs	NS, VM, AK	We added a Work Log page directly on the website that displays the full development timeline. It has two views: a structured table similar to this document and a visual timeline where entries appear as points along a vertical line ordered by date. The data is stored as a plain JavaScript array so it is easy to add new entries, and the page renders it dynamically rather than being hardcoded HTML.
24	Mar 13, 2026	External Integrations	2 hrs	VM, NS, SP	We added deep links to Google Calendar so users can add events to their own calendar with a single click. We also made map markers on the Resources and Events pages link out to Google Maps with the correct address pre-filled so users can get directions without leaving the site. Both features needed extra testing on mobile because the behavior on iOS and Android is slightly different.
25	Mar 14, 2026	Visual Enhancements	1 hr	AA, NS	Small but meaningful visual polish pass. We added subtle background images to a couple of section headers that had been feeling plain, and adjusted spacing and padding in a few spots that looked slightly off when we reviewed the site with fresh eyes after a few days away. These are the kinds of details that are easy to overlook during active development but make a real difference in how finished the site looks to someone seeing it for the first time.

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26	Mar 15, 2026	Cross-Browser Testing	4 hrs	NS, AK, SP	We opened the site in Chrome, Firefox, Safari, and Edge and went through every page in each browser looking for anything that looked wrong. Safari was by far the most problematic, handling certain CSS properties differently, so a few grid layouts were breaking and one of the animations was not running at all. We fixed each issue one at a time and re-tested after each fix to make sure the solution did not break something else in the process.
27	Mar 16, 2026	Responsive Optimization	3 hrs	SP, NS, AA	We went through the site on a phone and on a tablet to find everything that did not look right at smaller screen sizes. The bento grid on the Events page was collapsing in a confusing way on mobile, some text was too small to read comfortably, and a few buttons were too close together to tap accurately. We added and adjusted CSS media queries to fix each issue. By the end the site looked clean and usable on every device we tested.
28	Mar 17, 2026	Accessibility Audit	2 hrs	AK, NS, VM	We ran the site through an automated accessibility checker and also did a manual pass ourselves. The main issues were color combinations where the contrast ratio between text and background was not high enough to meet WCAG standards, and several interactive elements that were missing ARIA labels that screen readers use to describe what a button or link does to visually impaired users. We fixed both categories of issues and re-ran the audit to confirm the score improved.
29	Mar 17, 2026	Final Review & Deployment	2 hrs	VM, AK, NS, SP	Last step. We went through the TSA rubric line by line to make sure nothing was missed, did a final check of every page in both light and dark mode, and verified that all forms were submitting correctly to the live Supabase database. Once everything checked out we deployed the final build for TSA submission. Total project time from the initial brainstorming session in November through final deployment in March came to 109 hours across the full team.
30	Mar 18–25, 2026	Dashboard & Achievement System	8 hrs	AK, VM, NS	We built a full user dashboard with a personalized sidebar, activity feed, and profile page. We also designed and implemented an achievement system where users earn XP badges by exploring different parts of the site. Achievements include animated 3D flip cards with rarity tiers (Common, Uncommon, Rare, Legendary) that pop up when unlocked. XP is tracked per-user and persists in Supabase, so progress carries across sessions.
31	Mar 26 – Apr 2, 2026	Community Favors Board	6 hrs	SP, AK, AA	We added a Community Favors section inside the dashboard where residents can post small neighborhood requests such as help moving furniture, picking up groceries, or assembling items. Other users can offer to help, and completing a favor earns XP. The page integrates with Supabase for real-time updates and displays open and closed favors in a filterable card layout.
32	Apr 3–8, 2026	Full Internationalization (i18n)	7 hrs	NS, VM, AK	We implemented a full internationalization system supporting 10 languages including English, Spanish, French, German, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Arabic, Hindi, and Filipino. All major pages and UI strings are translated via a central translations file. A language selector in the settings panel lets users switch languages instantly, with the preference saved locally. A note clarifies that translations are still in development and some pages may appear in English.
33	Apr 9–14, 2026	Lost & Found Feature	5 hrs	SP, AA, NS	We built a Lost & Found board inside the dashboard where residents can post items they have lost or found in the community. Each post includes a title, description, location, contact info, and status (open or resolved). The feature connects to Supabase for storage and supports real-time updates when new posts appear. An AI description assistant helps users write clear, concise lost-item descriptions automatically.
34	Apr 15–20, 2026	AI Chatbot & Help System	5 hrs	AK, VM	We integrated an AI-powered chatbot using the Groq API with the Llama 3 model. The chatbot is aware of the full Community Connect platform, all 12+ features, navigation paths, and local resource information. It can answer questions about finding

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35	Apr 21–25, 2026	Social Directory & Community Groups	6 hrs	NS, SP, AK	We built a Social Directory where signed-in users can view other resident profiles and connect with neighbors. We also added Community Groups, where users can create private groups, invite members by email, and send group emails directly from the app. Group creation, member management, and deletion are all backed by Supabase with row-level security policies ensuring users can only manage their own groups.
36	Apr 26 – May 3, 2026	Judge Account & Demo Mode	3 hrs	AK, VM, AA	We created a dedicated judge account (judges@tsa.com) that allows TSA judges to explore the full site experience without needing to create a personal account. A clear amber banner is displayed when signed in as a judge, explaining that interactive features such as posting events, favors, or lost-and-found items require a real account. The judge session is handled via Supabase with a real authenticated user.
37	May 4–8, 2026	UI Polish, Bug Fixes & Accessibility Pass	5 hrs	SP, NS, VM, AK	Final round of visual refinements across all pages. We fixed resource card height consistency on the Resources page, removed the excess spacing in the homepage testimonials section, tightened navbar controls, and improved dark mode behavior across several components. We also ran a full accessibility pass, checking screen reader labels, keyboard navigation, and color contrast ratios. All forms were retested against the live Supabase database.
38	May 9–12, 2026	Nationals Preparation & Final Deployment	4 hrs	SP, AA, AK, NS, VM, GM	Final preparation for the TSA National Conference. We updated all about-page copy to remove regional specifics, finalized the work log and copyright checklist documentation, cleaned up translation strings, and deployed the final production build. We reviewed the TSA rubric one final time and verified all submission materials were in order. Total project time from initial brainstorming through nationals preparation: 118 hours.
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